

FAMILY ROAD TRIP · WESTERN CAPE

South Africa, *sun, penguins & safari*

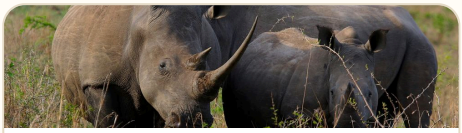
2 adults · Casper (7) · Lily (6) | 30 Dec 2026 → home 18 Jan 2027 | 2 homes · 3 safari nights · 1 hire car



Greyton · 9 nights
31 Dec – 9 Jan · Greyton Retreat · oak-lined village, Saturday market, river



Kommetjie · 5 nights
9 – 14 Jan · On the Beach holiday home · penguins, Cape Point, Table Mountain



Aquila safari · 3 nights
14 – 17 Jan · Family Cottage · Big Five, all meals and 2 game drives a day

Day by day

Drive times from OSRM without traffic · ★ = kids' favourite

Wed 30 Dec	**Fly overnight.** British Airways nonstop from Heathrow at 22:20.
OVERBERG · GREYTON	
Thu 31 Dec	**Land 12:10, collect the car.** Supermarket shop, then about 1 h 50 over Sir Lowry's Pass to Greyton. A quiet New Year's Eve in the garden.
Fri 1 Jan	**Slow day.** Sleep off the flight, river paddling and walks under the oaks.
Sat 2 Jan	**Greyton Saturday market.** Then next door to Genadendal's mission village and museum.
3 – 4 Jan	**Village days.** Cafés, the village pool, short trails and lazy garden afternoons.
Tue 5 Jan	**Stanford + Klein River canoeing** ★ About 1 h 15. Paddle the calm river, lunch in the village, then Grotto Beach in Hermanus.
6 – 7 Jan	**Coast day (option).** The Dyer Island boat from Gansbaai (about 1 h 35) for seals and penguins, or Stony Point penguins at Betty's Bay.
Fri 8 Jan	**Home day.** Garden, pool and a last braai in the village.
Sat 9 Jan	**Market, then to the sea.** One more Saturday market, then about 2 h 20 to Kommetjie. Sunset on Long Beach.
CAPE PENINSULA · KOMMETJIE	
Sun 10 Jan	**Kirstenbosch.** The Boomslang treetop walkway (about 35 min); a Sunday summer sunset concert if tickets are out.
Mon 11 Jan	**Boulders penguins** ★ Go at 08:00 (about 20 min), then Seaforth beach and fish and chips in Simon's Town.
Tue 12 Jan	**Cape Point** ★ Lighthouse, ostriches and baboons, then a picnic at Buffels Bay.
Wed 13 Jan	**Table Mountain cableway** ★ The first car up if the wind is down, then the Two Oceans Aquarium at the V&A.
KAROO · AQUILA PRIVATE GAME RESERVE	
Thu 14 Jan	**To the safari (about 2 h 50).** Camel rides at Imhoff Farm first, then via the Huguenot Tunnel. Check in, then the afternoon game drive.
15 – 16 Jan	**Big Five days** ★ Morning and afternoon game drives, the Junior Ranger programme, the pool and marshmallows by the fire. All meals included.
Sun 17 Jan	**Fly home.** Last morning drive and breakfast, then about 2 h 20 to the airport. Return the car; BA nonstop at 22:10.
Mon 18 Jan	**Home.** Land at Heathrow at 08:10.

Photos: Table Mountain, South African Tourism (CC BY 2.0); Greyton, Robvanvee (CC BY-SA 3.0); penguins, Satdeep Gill (CC BY-SA 4.0); rhino, Charles J. Sharp (CC BY-SA 4.0), all via Wikimedia Commons. Drive times are from OSRM routing without traffic, so add 20–30% in the holidays.

What it costs

GBP for the family of four · rand at **R21.92 = £1**
(mid-market rate, open.er-api.com, 16 Oct 2026)

Core costs

ITEM	BASIS	£
Flights, return × 4	British Airways nonstop: out Wed 30 Dec LHR 22:20 → CPT 12:10; back Sun 17 Jan CPT 22:10 → LHR 08:10. Economy, total for 2 adults + 2 children, Google Flights, 16 Oct. Virgin Atlantic nonstop is **£4,412** (out 21:10, back 19:35 or 21:00), £630 cheaper.	5,042
Greyton Retreat ↗, 31 Dec – 9 Jan	Airbnb total for 9 nights. Free cancellation before 1 Dec.	3,107
On the Beach, Kommetjie ↗, 9 – 14 Jan	Airbnb total for 5 nights. Free cancellation before 10 Dec.	1,264
Aquila Family Cottage ↗, 14 – 17 Jan	R72,440 for 3 nights from Aquila's booking engine (16 Oct): R24,680 a night on 14 and 15 Jan (peak), R23,080 on 16 Jan. The cottage is charged at 4 full rates, so the kids' 50% doesn't apply. Includes all meals, 2 game drives a day and stargazing; drinks extra. 100% due on booking.	3,305
Car hire, 7-seater, automatic	Suzuki Ertiga or similar, at the CPT terminal, 31 Dec – 17 Jan, £461 (Kayak, 16 Oct), plus 2 child seats at about R605 each (£55).	516
Fuel + tolls EST	About 1,500 km, including about 390 km for the Aquila drive and back to the airport, at about 7.5 L/100 km and R29.38/L (95 octane, coastal, Oct 2026, FIA), plus Chapman's Peak tolls.	165
Food & drink EST	15 days at about £110 a day (self-catering and a café or restaurant most days), plus 3 Aquila days at about £20 for drinks and snacks.	1,710
Daily extras EST	Parking, ice creams and small purchases: about £20 a day for 18 days.	360
Core total · about £3,867 per person		**£15,469**

Optional extras

★ = in "favourite extras" · 2 adults + 2 children aged 6–7

EXTRA	PRICE USED	RAND	£
★ Table Mountain cableway, return	R475 per adult, R230 per child (online, 2026/27) · tablemountain.net	1,410	64
★ Boulders penguins	R282 / R138, international rate from 1 Nov 2026 · SANParks	840	38
★ Cape Point (Cape of Good Hope)	R592 / R288 · same SANParks source. Funicular extra.	1,760	80
★ Two Oceans Aquarium	R280 per adult, R130 per child aged 4–13 · aquarium.co.za	820	37
★ Kirstenbosch summer concert	R360 per adult, R225 per child aged 6–21 (2025/26 prices; 2026/27 not yet out) · SANBI	1,170	53
★ Klein River canoeing, Stanford	River Rat: R100 per person, minimum R400 · capeinfo. Kayaks from Lady Stanford are R350–R500 each.	400	18
Dyer Island marine boat, Gansbaai	Seals, penguins and sharks (Dec–Jun). R2,340 per adult, R1,725 per child aged 5–11, + R150 each · sharkbookings	8,730	398
Favourite extras (★) · all extras £688			**£290**

CORE TRIP

£15,469

BA flights, 2 homes, 3 nights at Aquila, car, fuel, food and daily spend. With Virgin instead: £14,839.

CORE + FAVOURITE EXTRAS

£15,759

Adds the 6 ★ extras. With the Dyer Island boat as well: £16,157.

Aquila notes. Children aged 4–11 normally pay 50% of the adult rate, but the Family Cottage is priced as a 4-person unit. The Family Suite wasn't offered for these dates in the booking engine. The "Kids Stay Free This Holiday" offer covered only the SA winter school holidays (26 Jun – 19 Jul 2026), so it doesn't apply in January. Children aged 4+ go on drives.

Not included. Travel insurance, getting to and from Heathrow, the car's excess cover, and drinks at Aquila (soft drinks are R325 per person per night as an add-on). Aquila's cancellation terms: 30% charged within 30 days, 50% within 21 days and 100% within 7 days.

Prices were checked on 16 Oct 2026 and can change. Flights are Google Flights fares and homes are Airbnb totals. Rand prices are converted at R21.92 = £1. EST marks an estimate, not a quoted price.